



MYHISTAMATE GUIDE

The restaurant guide.

Eat out with confidence — without filling your histamine bucket.

FROM ME, TO YOU

For a long time I turned down restaurant invitations. Then I learned a few simple rules — and I could go out again, without fear. I'm leaving all of them here for you.

With love, Cătălina

Founder, MyHistamate

1

PREPARATION

Before you leave home

- **Choose the place in advance**

Not on an empty stomach, in a rush, at the door.

- **Read the menu online**

See ahead of time what you can order in peace.

- **Call and ask**

Good places are happy to answer questions.

- **Have a safe snack first**

On a big appetite, the temptation to slip is bigger.

IF YOU'RE PLANNING A FREER MEAL

Some people take a DAO enzyme supplement before a meal they know will be heavier — talk to your doctor first.

2

THE CHOICE

Which places are friendlier

SAFER

- Grill / rotisserie
- Simply cooked food
- Very fresh fish
- Home-style cooking
- Short menu
- Cooked to order
- Accepts changes
- Breakfast / brunch

RISKIER

- Sushi & canned food
- Cheeses & wines
- Cured meats / smoked
- Old street food
- Fermented (kimchi, pickles)
- Buffet / all-you-can-eat
- Tapas / cold platters
- Sauces you don't know

THE SIMPLE RULE

The fresher and simpler the food is cooked, the safer it is for you.

3

THE MENU

Look for words, not dishes

You don't need to know every dish. Watch how it's cooked:

GREEN WORDS

- Fresh
- Grilled
- Boiled
- Steamed
- Simple
- Baked
- Made to order
- Cooked on the spot

RED WORDS

- Aged
- Smoked
- Fermented
- Marinated
- Preserved
- In sauce
- Spicy
- Reduction / glazed

THE SIMPLE RULE

Don't focus on the name of the dish. Focus on how it was prepared.

USEFUL PHRASES

Ask without fear. It's your health.

Your questions aren't a bother. A good place wants you to feel well — and you're far from the only one who asks.

ASK YOURSELF QUICKLY

Is it fresh? Is it simple? Is it on the green list?

- **“Can it be cooked fresh, with no sauce and no cheese?”**
- **“Do you have something grilled and simple, with rice or potatoes?”**
- **“Is the meat / fish fresh, or has it been marinated?”**
- **“Could you put the olive oil on the side, with no dressing?”**

CHOOSE / AVOID

What to pick, what to skip

General examples — tolerance differs from one person to another.

CHOOSE

- Grilled chicken
- Turkey
- Freshly cooked beef
- Simple steak
- Rice
- Boiled / baked potatoes
- Steamed vegetables
- Green salad
- Olive oil

AVOID

- Aged cheeses
- Cured meats
- Olives
- Pickles
- Tuna / sardines
- Smoked fish
- Sushi
- Long stews
- Fermented sauces, vinegar
- Wine / beer
- Tomatoes & spinach
- Chocolate

THE SIMPLE RULE

You don't have to avoid all of these forever. The goal is to understand how you react to them and when it's worth being more careful.

BY CUISINE

Don't choose the cuisine, choose the dish

In almost any restaurant there are simple options — and options that add a lot to the bucket.

Italian

Yes: simple pasta, grilled meat, grilled vegetables.

No: parmesan, salami, tomato sauce.

Asian

Yes: rice, steamed chicken, vegetables with no sauce.

No: soy sauce, miso, edamame, kimchi, sushi.

Grill / BBQ

Yes: fresh grilled meat, potatoes, vegetables.

No: sausages, marinades, sauces, smoked meat.

Home-style

Yes: roast, clear soup, simple sides.

No: long stews, pickles.

Mexican

Yes: grilled chicken, rice, plain tortilla.

No: salsa, pickled jalapeños, sauces, aged dishes.

Mediterranean

Yes: grilled meat, rice, simple salad.

No: long-kept hummus, olives, pickles, sauces.

DRINKS

Staying hydrated keeps the bucket low

SAFER

- Still water
- Linden tea
- Mint tea
- Rooibos
- Lemonade without citrus

AVOID

- Wine & beer
- Any alcohol
- Black / green tea
- Kombucha
- Citrus juices

ALCOHOL AND DAO

Alcohol is doubly tricky: it adds histamine (especially wine and beer) and blocks the DAO enzyme at the same time. So it both fills the bucket and slows its draining. If you do choose to drink, some people with HIT tolerate simple distilled spirits (e.g. plain vodka or gin) better than wine, beer or fermented drinks — but tolerance is very individual.

CHECKLIST

At the restaurant

-
- ☐ I chose the place in advance
 - ☐ I read the menu beforehand
 - ☐ I asked how it's cooked
 - ☐ I chose fresh & simple
 - ☐ I drank water, not alcohol
 - ☐ I enjoyed the evening

BONUS

4 mistakes at the restaurant

- **Going hungry**
On a big appetite you choose worse.
- **Being too shy to ask**
It's your health — questions are normal.
- **“Just one glass of wine”**
Alcohol blocks DAO — the risk is high.
- **Forgetting the side & sauce**
That's where tomatoes, vinegar and cheese hide.

COMING SOON

Soon, you won't be alone at the table

I'm building the MyHistamate app: photograph the restaurant menu and instantly see what you can order safely — not a generic list, but advice tailored to your history and your reactions.

- **Photograph the menu**
See instantly what's green or red.
- **Real-time advice**
Tailored to your case, not generic.
- **Learns from your journal**
Over time, it gets to know you better.

JOIN THE WAITING LIST

Be among the first to try it. Sign up free at myhistamate.com and I'll let you know the moment we launch.

Go out and enjoy.

A meal out shouldn't be a test. With a few simple choices, the restaurant becomes what it should be again: a joy.

[Discover MyHistamate](#)

This guide is for informational purposes only and does not replace professional medical advice. Histamine intolerance varies greatly from person to person — always consult your doctor before making significant changes to your diet or treatment.